

Common Application | Undergraduate

Emerson Nguyen | CAID: APP_017 | Fall 2026

Applicant information

App ID	APP_017
First Name	Emerson
Last Name	Nguyen
Date Of Birth	6/13/09
Mailing Address	1016 Sample Avenue, Columbus, OH 43215
Primary Phone Number	614-555-0116
Email Address	emerson.nguyen.017@example.com
Gender	Not provided
Ethnicity	Asian
Country	USA
Region	Midwest

Education and application details

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Name of HS	Columbus High School
Counselor Name	Taylor Wilson
Intended Major	Environmental Science
Admission Year	2026
Admission Term	F
Unweighted GPA	3.92
Weighted GPA	4.7
Rank	Not provided
Superscored SAT Score	Not provided
Superscored ACT Score	Not provided

AP Courses

AP English Literature, AP Research, AP Seminar, AP Psychology, AP US History, AP Statistics, AP Computer Science A

Total APs

7

IB Courses

Not provided

Total IBs

Not provided

Activities

Science club member, Drama club performer, Coding club member, Yearbook photographer, Chess club member

Awards

School academic honor roll

Hooks

First gen

Personal essay

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Prompt: Describe an experience that changed how you think or learn.

The observation I almost discarded

In science club, an unexpected result seemed like a mistake to hide. When we compared our notes, the difference became the most interesting part of the discussion. It forced us to examine our method instead of repeating our conclusion.

My first response was to make the problem smaller than it really was. I wanted a neat explanation and a quick result. When that did not work, I felt embarrassed by how much I had assumed. Looking back, the useful part of the experience began when I admitted that I needed more information. I wrote down what I knew, what I was guessing, and what I still needed to ask. That simple separation helped me move forward without pretending to be certain.

The next attempt was slower. I listened to another perspective, changed one part of my approach, and checked whether the change made sense. I learned that revision is more than replacing a wrong answer with a right one. Sometimes it means changing the question itself. I also learned to explain my choices clearly enough that someone else could challenge them. An idea became more useful when it could survive a conversation rather than only look convincing in my notebook.

That lesson has followed me into ordinary parts of my school life. When I do not understand a reading, I try to identify the sentence where I lost the argument. When a group disagrees, I ask what each person is trying to accomplish. These habits do not solve every problem, and I still sometimes rush toward an answer. But they give me a way to begin again. I am becoming more comfortable saying that I have not figured something out yet, provided that I can describe the next step I will take.

My interest in Environmental Science comes partly from this experience. I want to study how ideas meet the complicated conditions of actual lives. I hope college will give me stronger methods, unfamiliar perspectives, and people who will question my assumptions. I do not expect every class to confirm the direction I have chosen. I want some of them to make me reconsider it. Learning should enlarge the questions I can ask as well as the answers I can offer.

The lesson I carry with me is to treat an unexpected result as a reason to investigate. It sounds modest, but it changes how I work. I now see patience, curiosity, and a willingness to revise as practical responsibilities. I want to contribute to a college community by taking other people seriously, making my reasoning clear, and continuing when a first attempt fails. The moment that matters most to me is no longer the moment I can announce an answer. It is the moment I understand enough to take a more thoughtful next step.

Essay is fictional and generated for this prototype. It is embedded in this CommonApp document.